

away with the folder structure that all Web-mail providers had, and introduce the idea of labels and conversations—so when someone replies to a mail that you sent, it's displayed along with your mail, and all replies from there on are displayed in chronological order. Gmail also offered 1 GB of storage space, and this at a time when other mail providers were offering a mere 4 MB! With a Gmail account, you could send e-mails with attachments that were larger than the total storage space available on other free e-mail providers. Thanks to Gmail, the other providers were forced to offer users more account space—so whether you have a Google account or not, you are reaping the benefits of what Gmail introduced to the world.

April 14: The Lindows case

Lindows changes its name to Linspire. Linux distros were always considered to be something that geeks used. Terminal windows, commands, and all those geeky things that caused the average Windows user to shudder at the mention of the word “Linux” were done away with in one particular Linux distribution called Lindows. Now any idiot can see that the word Lindows comes from a merger of “Linux” and “Windows,” and this is what got it into trouble. Lindows was, very shamelessly, a distro that did everything it could to copy Windows, so that if one shifted over to Windows from Lindows, the change would hardly be perceptible. This, of course, prompted Microsoft to sue, and often. Lindows had lawsuits filed against it in several countries, including France and the US. Lindows finally gave up and succumbed to Microsoft's might, and changed its name to Linspire.

August 3: And then, Doom 3

The much awaited sequel in the Doom series of video games, Doom 3 was released to the world. This first-person shooter is known for being scary and abounds with jumpy moments for fans. At the time of the release, no one had seen anything quite like Doom 3—the graphics were great, the shadow effects superlative and the gameplay could stop hearts because of some really scary-looking monsters. The only thing that ruined the experience was